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Alexander Bernhardt
Magilano
Lindenstraße 49a
57627 Hachenburg
Germany

Dear Mr. Bernhardt,

A few weeks ago, my friend and colleague, Cliff Gertiser, wrote to you on my behalf, asking about the digital rights to SKYJO. We worked together for many years and I trust his judgment. Since he is in Europe and fluent in several languages, I asked him to help facilitate any discussions that might come about.

I wanted to write to you myself to find out if there is any possibility of working together. I, too, have worked independently for many years. I have developed mobile applications for a wide range of businesses, from very large corporations to single-person shops, but have never desired to build a large company myself. I value the freedom that comes from having a small team or working solo.

I am asking about licensing SKYJO because I see an opportunity to build something that meets a need for the customers who love your work. They routinely search for SKYJO on the iOS and Android app stores, but only weak clones of your game are available. I want to build a version that you can be proud of and that your customers would love. You have built a solid business on the strength of your work and intellectual property. A mobile game done well would build on that without diminishing how your fans see your games.

I found SKYJO this summer while looking for popular games that are multi-generational in appeal. My wife and I played many board and card games with our four children over the years and now greatly enjoy doing so with our grandchildren as well. SKYJO fits with the types of games we love.

SKYJO brings people together without electronics (a very healthy goal) and allows conversation and interaction between the various ages to flow naturally. My long-term goal for a mobile game would be to allow that same interaction between generations who are not able to be together in the same physical space. The first step towards that goal is to develop a single-player version that captures the gameplay well in an engaging and fun way. If that is successful, moving to a multi-player version would be a natural follow-on.

Your game's reputation is very important and I am happy to discuss whatever safeguards you would want to put into place to ensure a mobile game does not take anything away from that. I know there are several versions of your game in the iOS and Android app stores that are attempting to make money from your customers without any credit or payment to you. Both stores have mechanisms for addressing this without resorting to the courts, and those mechanisms work far better once an official version of the game exists.

To be sure I wasn't writing to you about something I only imagined I could build, I built a working version of the game first. It plays the rules correctly, and the computer opponents play a genuinely competitive game — that part took real work, and I'm pleased with how well it plays. The user interface and graphics are deliberately rudimentary. It's a private technical proof, nothing more, and it stays that way unless you say otherwise. I've enclosed a few screenshots, and if you're curious, the QR code below links to a short recording of a full game:
https://www.ivygulch.com/skyjo/skyjodemo.html

I would love to have a short conversation about whether the digital rights to SKYJO are available, and what an official version might look like if they are. Email is the easiest way to reach me — dwsjoquist@ivygulch.com — though the phone number above works too, and I'm happy to account for the time difference. And if the rights are already committed elsewhere, or this simply isn't a direction you want to go, I'd be grateful to know that too. Either way, please take it as a compliment: your game is good enough that a stranger in Ohio built a prototype just to earn the chance to ask.

Thank you for reading this far, and congratulations on what you've built with SKYJO.

Best regards,

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Enclosures: prototype screenshots